

MARKETING BOOKLET ・ UNIT OF WORK

JDM YARD

REAL PARTS. REAL OWNERS. REAL PERFORMANCE.

A parts brand built for the
JDM car subculture.

Featuring the Nissan 370Z (Z34)

本物のパーツ。本物のパフォーマンス。



SUBCULTURE

JDM ・ JAPANESE DOMESTIC MARKET CAR CULTURE

DESIGNER

@jdmyard ・ ISSUE 01 / 2026

CONTENTS

This booklet presents JDM YARD — a Japanese performance parts brand designed and marketed for the JDM car subculture. It follows the research into the group, the meaning of their symbols, the design of the product, and the plan for selling it to them.

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The brand's hero car: a Nissan 370Z (Z34) — photographed for the campaign and used across the magazine, website and posters.

01 SECTION INTRODUCTION / ABOUT

JDM YARD is an online store and brand that sells parts for Japanese performance cars, aimed directly at the JDM car subculture in Australia. The name says exactly what it is — a “yard” of Japanese Domestic Market parts — so it reads as insider language straight away.

WHAT THE PRODUCT IS

- An online parts store (jdmyard.com) selling six categories: exhaust & exterior, interior parts, lighting, aero parts, wheels & accessories, and performance.
- A printed magazine-style zine — JDM YARD Issue 01 — sent free in every order and handed out at meets.
- Limited-run merchandise, posters and sticker packs carrying the brand mark.

WHAT SUBCULTURE IT TARGETS

The JDM (Japanese Domestic Market) car subculture — people who own, build, tune and photograph Japanese performance cars. The core buyer is 18–30, active on Instagram, TikTok and YouTube, and spends real money on their build.

AT A GLANCE

BRAND	JDM YARD
PRODUCT	JDM parts store + print zine
HERO CAR	Nissan 370Z (Z34)
MARKET	Australia, shipped nationwide
CORE BUYER	Enthusiasts aged 18–30
PRICE RANGE	\$8 stickers – \$3,000 wheels



本物のパーツ

REAL PARTS

THE IDEA, BRIEFLY

Most parts websites look like spreadsheets — grey, cheap and full of fakes. JDM YARD treats parts retail like the culture treats cars: dark, high-contrast, motorsport-styled, with Japanese type, real owner cars and honest specifications. The shop, the magazine and the poster all use one visual language so the brand feels like it belongs to the scene rather than advertising at it.

POSITIONING STATEMENT

“Genuine and quality aftermarket JDM parts, sold by people who actually understand the cars — shipped Australia-wide.”

DEFINITION & DEMOGRAPHICS

JDM stands for Japanese Domestic Market. Strictly, it means cars and parts built by Japanese manufacturers to be sold inside Japan only. The term has since grown into a worldwide subculture based on owning, tuning and modifying Japanese performance cars, mostly from the 1980s onwards. Hero models — the Nissan Skyline GT-R (R32/R33/R34), Toyota Supra MK4, Mazda RX-7 FD, Honda Civic and Integra Type R, Subaru WRX STI, Mitsubishi Lancer Evolution and the Nissan Z cars — are treated almost like celebrities inside the community.

To most people a car is just transport. In this subculture the car is self-expression — so members reject the ordinary “standard” car and personalise everything: engine, body kit, wheels and paint.

DEMOGRAPHICS OF THE GROUP

AGE

Mostly 16–35. Younger fans (16–24) arrive through games, anime and social media; the core (25–35) can actually afford to buy and modify; collectors (35–50+) chase rare classics.

GENDER

Mainly male but increasingly mixed — more female enthusiasts, builders and drift drivers are visible online, so the brand must not assume an all-male audience.

NATIONALITY

Global. Strong scenes in Japan, Australia, the USA, the UK, Canada, the UAE and across South-East Asia and Europe. JDM YARD targets the Australian scene first.

CULTURAL IDENTITY

A mix of Japanese heritage, street-racing and drift culture from the mountain “touge” roads, motorsport, and pop culture such as Initial D and Gran Turismo.

Many members see themselves as knowledgeable “insiders” who respect the culture rather than follow a trend. For a designer this is critical: the product has to feel authentic enough to be accepted by those insiders, or it gets dismissed instantly.

The kind of detail this audience actually spends money on — the owner's own car.



INTERESTS, BELIEFS & LIFESTYLE

HOBBIES & ACTIVITIES

- Modifying and tuning — engine swaps, turbo upgrades, suspension, aero
- Car meets, shows and track days
- Drifting and grassroots motorsport
- Photography and video — posting car content on Instagram, YouTube, TikTok
- Racing games and sim racing
- Hunting rare OEM and aftermarket parts

VALUES & BELIEFS

- Authenticity over fakes — honest builds earn respect, a fake “ricer” car does not
- Craftsmanship — doing the work yourself
- Heritage and nostalgia for 80s/90s Japanese engineering
- Individuality — every build is personal
- Community — sharing knowledge, trading parts
- “Form and function” — look good and perform

LIFESTYLE & ATTITUDES

- Passionate and detail-obsessed; will spend real money and time
- Slightly rebellious and anti-mainstream
- Strong brand loyalty — Nissan, Honda and Mazda fans act like rival teams
- Style tribes exist: Bosozoku, Stance, VIP and Time Attack

“For this group, the car is an identity — not just a vehicle.”

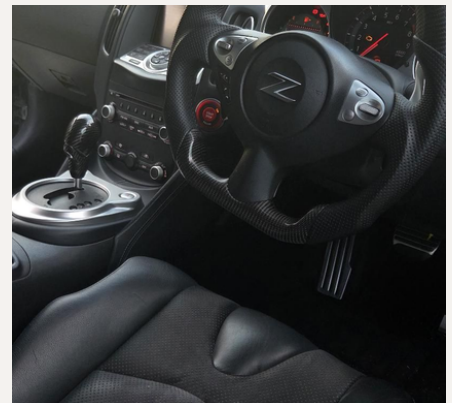
RESEARCH FINDING · SHARED BELIEFS



Engine bay — craftsmanship and “doing it properly”



Wheels and stance — status, taste and commitment



Interior — the driver-focused, form-and-function attitude

WHAT THIS MEANS FOR JDM YARD

Every value in this research points at the same product decision: stock genuine and quality parts, explain them honestly, show real owner cars instead of stock photos, and make the packaging and print worth keeping. The brand should reward knowledge, not hide it.

04 VISUAL / SEMIOTIC ANALYSIS

SIGNS & SYMBOLS

This section looks at the signs and symbols the subculture uses, and what they actually mean to the people inside it. The terms signifier, denotation and connotation are used because they matter when analysing meaning.

SIGNIFIERS — ICONS & SYMBOLS

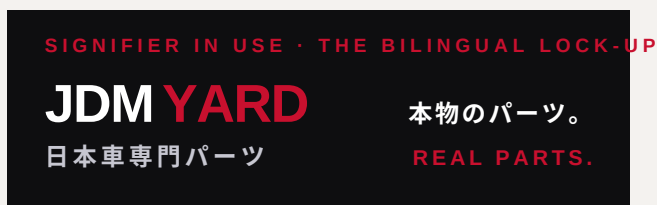
- Brand and tuning logos — the GT-R badge, the Honda “H”, and tuner names like Nismo, Mugen, Spoon, HKS, TRD and Advan
- The Japanese rising sun motif, plus katakana and kanji text on liveries and stickers
- Wheels — the Volk TE37 and deep-dish Work wheels are treated as sacred symbols of taste
- Sounds — the rotary “braaap”, the blow-off valve “psh” and the boxer rumble
- Low stance, wide fenders and aggressive camber
- Clothing and merch — branded hoodies, racing jackets, lanyards

HOW JDM YARD USES THESE SIGNIFIERS

- Japanese type set beside English (the store header reads “Japanese car specialist parts” in kanji) — this signals heritage and insider knowledge.
- A red / black / off-white palette borrowed from motorsport and the Japanese flag, never bright or novelty colours.
- Magazine layout language: issue numbers, technical data strips, numbered plates — signifying seriousness and real information.
- Real photographs of a real owner's car, which signifies honesty and rejects fakes.



Mood board of subculture signifiers collected during research: rising sun, kanji plates, TRD / NISMO / Mugen marks, the AE86 and Supra, koi tattoo art and “Tokyo Drift” neon.



English display type carries the meaning to every reader; the kanji and katakana carry the cultural signal to the people inside the subculture. Both are needed for the brand to be read correctly.

SIGNIFIERS ON THE CAR ITSELF



Badging, spoiler, smoked tail lights and a low stance — the owner's car is already covered in signifiers. The brand's job is to sell the parts that create them, using the same language.

MEANING & MISREADING

DENOTATION VS CONNOTATION

SIGNIFIER	DENOTATION (LITERAL)	CONNOTATION (MEANING TO THE GROUP)
Nismo / Mugen badge	A performance parts brand logo	Authenticity, motorsport history, “the real deal”
Volk TE37 wheels	A lightweight forged wheel	Status, good taste and serious commitment
Rising sun / kanji decals	Japanese imagery and writing	Loyalty and respect to the Japanese roots of the culture
Loud modified exhaust	A car sound	Presence, individuality and belonging
Low stance / camber	The car's height and wheel angle	Style and dedication — giving up comfort for identity

COULD ANYONE MISINTERPRET THESE SYMBOLS?

Yes — and this matters as a designer, because the same symbol carries different meanings for different audiences:

- A loud exhaust and a low car signify passion and craftsmanship to insiders, but to the wider public, older people or the police they can signify “boy racer”, antisocial behaviour or reckless driving.
- The rising sun motif reads as heritage and pride to enthusiasts, but in some countries it carries negative historical and political meanings, so it is easily misread.
- Big wings and body kits signify serious performance to the group, but outsiders may dismiss them as fake “ricer” styling.

WHY THIS MATTERS FOR THE DESIGN

JDM YARD deliberately uses the coded symbols insiders recognise — Japanese type, motorsport red, technical data, real cars — but avoids the rising sun flag and “boy racer” imagery. The result speaks fluently to the subculture while still looking premium and legitimate to parents, retailers and the wider public who see the packaging or the website.

MOOD BOARD

The mood board fixes the visual direction before any layout is made: what the culture looks like, the colours it uses, the type it uses, and the tone the brand has to hit.



WHAT WAS TAKEN FROM IT

- Palette: black, off-white and a single motorsport red.
- Bilingual type — English display type locked with Japanese kana and kanji.
- Photographic tone: night-time, low light, wet tarmac, garage lighting.
- Print references: magazine covers, stickers, number plates, workshop labels.
- Icons kept: TRD / NISMO / Mugen style marks, kanji plates, tuner silhouettes.
- Icons avoided: rising sun flag, cartoon or novelty imagery.

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07 THE PRODUCT / DESIGN

DEVELOPMENT & SKETCHES



Final poster / magazine cover — JDM YARD Issue 01. A2 print, built on a strict grid: masthead, hero image, Japanese feature headline, three-frame photo strip and a technical data footer.

DESIGN DECISIONS

- Masthead set in heavy condensed capitals so it reads across a room at a car meet.
- A Japanese feature headline meaning “legends of the strongest Z”, to signal authenticity to insiders rather than translate for outsiders.
- Issue number and date block, copied from real Japanese car magazines.
- Technical data strip — engine, displacement, power, torque, 0–100, kerb weight — because this audience respects real numbers.
- Photo strip of the owner's own car, captioned like an editorial feature.

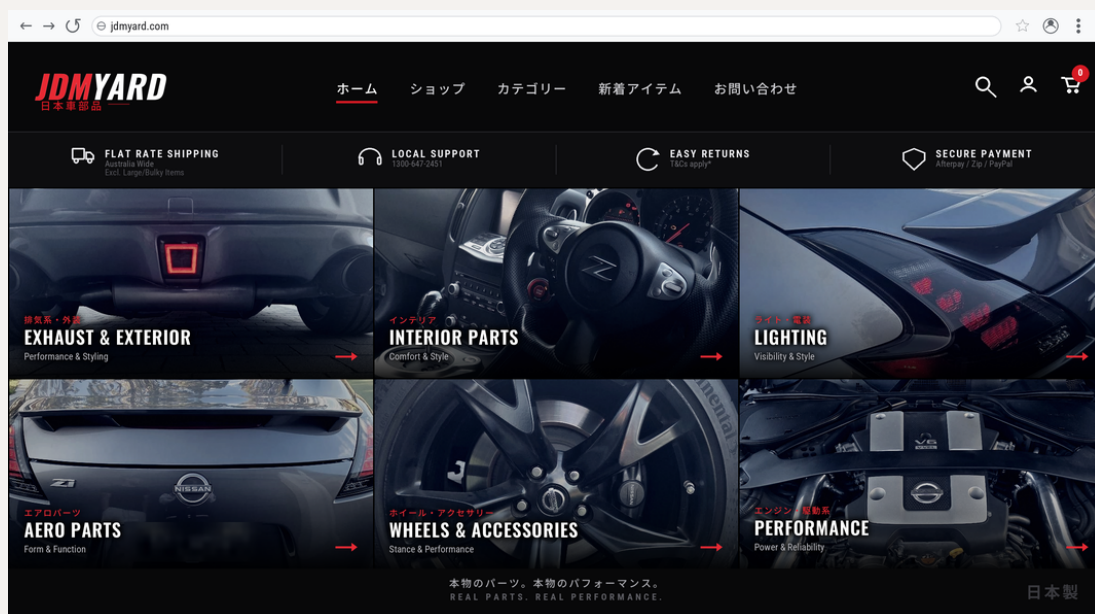
SKETCH DEVELOPMENT

MOUNT SCANNED SKETCHES HERE

(hand-drawn masthead, layout thumbnails, sticker ideas)

Layout thumbnails and masthead lettering were sketched by hand first, then rebuilt digitally. The printed sketch page is filed with this booklet for checking.

STORE & CONTACT SHEET



jdmyard.com — the store applies the same design system: dark interface, bilingual category labels, six shopping categories, and a service bar promising flat-rate Australia-wide shipping, local support, easy returns and secure payment.

PHOTOGRAPHY · CONTACT SHEET

Nine frames were shot for the campaign and contact-sheeted for selection. The three exterior frames (golden hour, front end, three-quarter) were chosen for the poster strip, while the detail frames — wheel, engine bay, interior and diffuser — became the six store category tiles.



09 SECTION

MARKETING PLAN

KEY FEATURES

- Genuine JDM and quality aftermarket parts across six categories.
- Model-specific fitment — search by chassis code (Z34, S15, FD3S, R34).
- Flat-rate shipping Australia-wide; local phone support on 1300 647 2451.
- Easy returns and secure payment — Afterpay, Zip and PayPal.
- Free JDM YARD magazine and sticker pack in every order.

WHY IT APPEALS TO THE SUBCULTURE

- It uses the culture's own visual language instead of generic retail styling.
- It backs the values the group ranks highest: authenticity, heritage and quality.
- Limited runs and customisable options let buyers feel individual yet part of the club.
- Real numbers and real cars respect the group's obsession with knowledge.

WHO WILL BUY IT

- Primary: male and female enthusiasts 18–30 who own a JDM car or badly want one — active on social media, attend meets, and display their identity through what they buy.
- Secondary: younger fans 16–18 buying affordable merch, posters and stickers.
- Tertiary: collectors paying more for premium, limited-edition pieces.

WHERE IT WILL BE SOLD

- Online at jdmyard.com — the main channel.
- Instagram shop and TikTok Shop links for impulse merch.
- Stalls at car meets, shows and track days, where the poster and zine do the selling.
- Selected local workshops stocking consumables and stickers.

HOW IT WILL BE ADVERTISED

SOCIAL MEDIA

Instagram and TikTok reels: install clips, before-and-after builds, dyno results. Short, loud, vertical.

CREATORS

Paid and gifted partnerships with Australian car content creators and drift drivers — parts fitted on camera.

PRINT

The Issue 01 poster handed out at meets, plus stickers in every box — cheap, long-lasting advertising on real cars.

OWNER FEATURES

Customers' cars featured in the magazine and on the site, which turns buyers into advocates.



SALES FUNNEL, SIMPLIFIED

- See the car content on Instagram or TikTok → follow the account.
- Meet the brand in person at a car meet → take a free poster and stickers.
- Buy a small part or merch item → receive Issue 01 in the box.
- Come back for the expensive parts — wheels, exhaust and aero.

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SECTION

CONCLUSION / CALL TO ACTION

WHY THIS PRODUCT SUCCEEDS FOR THIS SUBCULTURE

JDM YARD works because every decision came out of the research rather than being decorated on afterwards. The subculture values authenticity, craftsmanship, heritage and knowledge — so the brand sells genuine parts, publishes real specifications, photographs real owner cars, and sets Japanese type next to English to show it understands where the culture came from. The semiotic research also told the brand what to leave out, which is why the rising sun and “boy racer” signals are avoided: they read badly outside the group and would cost the brand legitimacy.

The result is one consistent identity across three touchpoints — the store, the magazine and the poster — aimed at a defined buyer, sold through the channels that buyer already uses, and priced so both a 17-year-old buying a sticker pack and a collector buying forged wheels can join in.

BUILD IT PROPERLY.

Shop the full range at jdmyard.com, follow @jdmyard for build content, and grab Issue 01 free with your first order. Real parts. Real owners. Real performance.

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